LAUNCHPAD PREP GUIDE

How to pass an assessment centre

What to expect on an Amazon apprenticeship assessment centre day, and how to prepare.

What an assessment centre is

An assessment centre is a set of tasks that an employer uses to see how you work. Instead of one interview, you do several activities, often alongside other people applying for the same role. It is usually one of the last steps before an employer decides who to hire.

At Amazon, the assessment centre is held online. You meet the team and may be asked to take part in a group task, give a short presentation, have interviews and do other tasks linked to the programme you applied for.

Where it fits in the Amazon process

Step	What happens
1. Online application	You upload your CV, answer some questions to check you can apply, and do a short quiz about how you like to work.
2. Online assessment	A test made like a game. It checks your strengths and whether the role suits you.
3. Video interview	You record short answers about yourself, at a time that suits you. You can use a laptop, tablet or phone.
4. Online assessment centre	Group task, presentation, interviews and other tasks. This guide is about this step.

What the assessors are looking for

The people watching you (the assessors) are not only checking whether you get the right answer. They want to see how you:

- work with other people
- deal with problems
- share your ideas and listen to others
- behave when things do not go to plan

Amazon says its assessments and interviews focus heavily on its Leadership Principles. These are 16 short statements about how Amazon expects people to work. You do not need to learn them all word for word, but you should know what they mean. Two that Amazon apprenticeship managers mention often are:

- **Ownership** - you take responsibility for your work and you do not say "that is not my job".
- **Learn and Be Curious** - you keep learning, ask questions and want to improve.

> **Tip**
>
> Before the day, read all 16 principles and pick 3 or 4 that fit you best. Think of a real example from your life for each one.

The tasks you might do

Group task

You work with other candidates to solve a problem or make a plan in a set time. The assessors watch how the group works together.

- Speak up early so the assessors hear your voice, but do not talk over people.
- Ask quieter people what they think. Bringing others in shows teamwork.
- Keep an eye on the time and the goal. Offering to keep track of time is a useful role.
- If you disagree, say so politely and explain why. Once the group decides, support the decision.

Presentation

You may be given a topic to prepare before the day, or a short time to prepare on the day.

- Use a simple structure: what you will talk about, your main points, then a short summary.
- Practise out loud and time yourself. Most people speak faster when they are nervous.
- Keep slides simple, with a few words on each one.
- Expect questions at the end. It is fine to take a moment to think before you answer.

Interviews

These are usually questions about times you showed a skill, such as "Tell me about a time you solved a problem". Use real examples from school, college, part-time work, sport, clubs or volunteering. See the Interview preparation tips guide for how to answer these well.

Before the day

1. Read every email Amazon sends you, and check the date, time and what you need to prepare.
2. Re-read the programme description and note the skills it asks for.
3. Read the Leadership Principles and prepare 4 to 6 short examples from your own life.
4. Look back at your CV and application, because interviewers may ask about them.
5. Practise with a friend or family member, including a mock group discussion if you can.
6. Test your laptop, camera, microphone and internet connection, and try the video software beforehand.
7. Choose a quiet, well-lit place, and tell people at home not to disturb you.
8. Get a good night's sleep.

On the day

- Log in 10 minutes early, with your camera on and your phone on silent.
- Have water, a pen and paper nearby for notes.
- Be friendly and polite to everyone, including other candidates. Assume you are being watched the whole time, including short breaks.

- Read or listen to each task brief carefully. If something is unclear, ask.
- Explain your thinking out loud so the assessors can follow how you reached your answer.
- If one task goes badly, let it go and focus on the next one. One weaker task does not mean you have failed the day.

If you need extra support

If you have a disability or a health condition, you can ask for changes that help you take part, such as extra time. Amazon has a team called ACAT (Applicant Candidate Accommodation Team) for this. Ask as early as you can, and explain what you need and how it will help.

Afterwards

You may hear back within a few days. If you are not successful, ask for feedback. Many people do several assessment centres before getting an offer, and each one helps you do better next time.

Quick checklist

[ ] I know the date, time and link

[ ] I have prepared anything Amazon asked for

[ ] I have 4 to 6 examples ready

[ ] My equipment and internet have been tested

[ ] I have a quiet place to sit

[ ] I have asked for any support I need

Where this advice comes from

This guide was written from these sources, checked in October 2026. Amazon can change its process, so always read the instructions it sends you.

- Amazon Apprenticeships - Application Support
- Amazon Leadership Principles
- 5 things you need to know when applying for an Amazon apprenticeship
- Prospects - Assessment centres
- National Careers Service - Interview tips
- GOV.UK - Getting an apprenticeship